STRAIGHT ARROW
TRAFFIC CONTROL

CODE OF SAFE PRACTICES

Straight Arrow Traffic Control Inc. | Chapter 4 of the Health and Safety Manual, issued as a standalone posting | v1.2, Effective October 1, 2026 | Revised October 15, 2026

This Code is posted at each job location and reviewed at orientation and in regular safety meetings. It states minimum requirements; the Health and Safety Manual and the pre-task plan govern the details of each task.

GENERAL SAFE PRACTICES

1. All work is performed under this Code, the Health and Safety Manual, and the pre-task plan (JHA) for the task. The plan names the heaviest or most repetitive manual handling, the aid or method to be used, and who rotates. When the work changes, the plan changes first.

2. Every employee has the authority and the duty to stop any work they believe is unsafe. No employee will be disciplined for a good-faith stop or report.

3. Report every injury, near miss, and instance of property, equipment, or utility damage to your supervisor before the end of the shift.

4. Report to work fit for duty: free of impairment from alcohol, drugs, medications that impair, and fatigue. Disclose impairing medications before the shift.

5. Required PPE is worn in all designated areas: hard hat, safety glasses, high-visibility apparel, safety-toe boots, and gloves suited to the task, plus task-specific PPE per the plan.

6. Horseplay, fighting, and pranks are prohibited on all work premises.

7. Keep work areas clean as the work proceeds: walkways clear, cords and hoses out of paths, nails removed or bent, materials stacked stable, spills cleaned or guarded immediately.

8. Inspect tools and equipment before use. Defective tools and equipment are tagged out of service and turned in, never used carefully.

9. Machine guards and safety devices stay in place and functional. Removing or defeating a guard is a serious violation.

10. Cord-connected tools operate on GFCI protection. Damaged cords are removed from service; grounding pins are never removed.

11. Ladders are inspected before use, set on firm level footing, and climbed with three points of contact facing the ladder. Consider a lift or scaffold before choosing a ladder.

12. Use mechanical means or a lifting aid first: forklift, dolly, cart, hoist, or the aid named in the plan. One person lifts no more than 50 pounds alone under good conditions; 50 to 100 pounds is a team lift or mechanical; over 100 pounds is mechanical, always. Keep loads close and turn with the feet, not the back. Rotate high-repetition and high-vibration tasks where the work allows. Report aches, pain, numbness, tingling, or loss of grip to your supervisor the same day; reporting is never disciplined.

13. Never dry-cut, dry-grind, or dry-sweep concrete, masonry, or asphalt. Use water or vacuum dust controls, always.

14. Wear hearing protection in posted areas and around high-noise equipment.

15. Follow the heat illness prevention program: drink water throughout the shift, use shade, take cool-down rests when needed, and watch coworkers for symptoms.

16. Know the emergency plan for your location: alarm, muster point, and who calls 911. Never move a seriously injured person except to prevent further injury, and never drive yourself for treatment of a serious injury.

17. Seatbelts are worn in every vehicle and every machine so equipped. Handheld phone use while operating is prohibited. A spotter is required whenever backing or offloading where any person could be in the path or vision is limited. Working alone, a documented walk-around immediately before the move is the accepted alternative.

18. Only trained and authorized employees operate equipment, machinery, or vehicles, or perform work requiring certification.

FLAGGING OPERATIONS

19. Flaggers hold current ATSSA Flagger certification and carry the card on station.

20. Flagger stations are positioned so approaching drivers can stop in time, with an escape route kept open at all times.

21. Never turn your back on approaching traffic. Never leave the station until relieved or the operation is shut down.

22. Paired flaggers release traffic only on each other's confirmation.

23. Phone and earbud use on station is prohibited.

TRAFFIC CONTROL SETUPS

24. Closures are installed per the approved traffic control plan, complete with advance warning, taper, buffer, work space, and termination.

25. The buffer space remains empty of workers, equipment, and material at all times.

26. Devices are placed with traffic (signs first) and removed against the installation order (termination first), facing traffic whenever the operation allows.

27. Weather or visibility that defeats the closure's warning distance suspends the operation.

WORK NEAR LIVE TRAFFIC

28. Never step into a live traffic lane outside established traffic control.

29. Wear Class 2 high-visibility apparel minimum; Class 3 at night. Face traffic when the task allows; when it does not, another person watches.

30. Position vehicles as protection between traffic and the work where practical, and identify the escape route before starting.

31. Work requiring more than a brief shoulder stop requires devices or a closure per the CA MUTCD, arranged through supervision.

RAILROAD RIGHT-OF-WAY SETUPS

32. Setups within railroad right-of-way occur only with railroad protection activated: briefing complete, protection established, personnel badged.

33. Tracks are live until the railroad briefing states otherwise; adjacent tracks are included. Move to the clear point immediately on signal.

Stop work authority applies to every rule above. Questions, hazards, and anonymous reports: Corporate Safety, Sergio Robles, 626-366-2912.